

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

How much is a picture *really* worth?



Learning Outcome

Express duty, advice, willingness, or intention to do something in spoken or written texts and in work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- In your opinion, why do people say "a picture is worth a thousand words"?
- Do you agree with this expression? Why or why not?

Can Do Statements

- I can request or report about the purpose of events or actions related to job issues.
- I can discuss reasons and results of an event or an action related to work and jobs.
- I can give descriptions about how a visual presentation could be enriched.



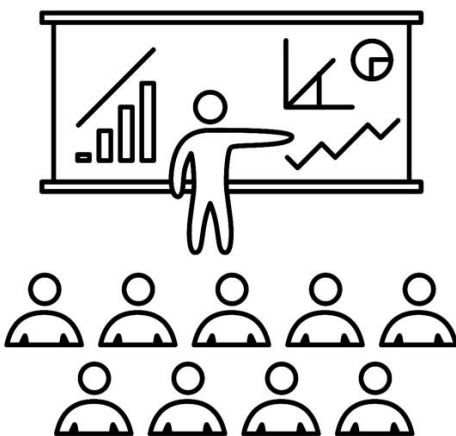


Let's Explore!

Kristi reads a brochure about making an **effective*** and **efficient**** visual presentation.

* Something that is "effective" successfully does what it is supposed to do.

** Something that is "efficient" does what it is supposed to do quickly using minimal resources.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

PowerPoint presentations are a great way to support a speech in order to focus attention on a subject. However, a bad presentation can lead to the opposite result, because of poor design choices. Following these suggestions will be useful for avoiding the most common mistakes. It has been claimed that presentations should be very appealing to look at. However, it has not been mentioned as much that the messages on your page, either through words, images or illustrations, are much more important than anything else. In reality, each slide should be very basic and simple owing to our limited attention spans. Secondly, it has been pointed out that it is important to be consistent in your choices. You should use the same font face and sizes on all slides. Presenters are often requested to use a font size that is large enough to read from a distance. If you want to play with colors, always keep contrast in mind so as to ensure that the text is easy to read. If you use your company logo, choose contrasting colors for other elements on the slide. A poor choice of colors can shatter a presentation due to unattractive combinations. If you're unsure which colors match best, you can find a website to get a set of matching colors. Thirdly, when you are drafting your message, remember the golden rule: KIS (Keep It Simple). Images are key elements of every presentation. They say that a picture is worth a thousand words. Your audience wants to have a visual representation of what you're talking about in order to better understand your message. You should be talking freely, not reading your text. The tendency to read all the words on a slide is so common that most presenters only use keywords. Whether you are describing your data or explaining circumstances, you'll want to tell a story. That's how the human brain works.





Let's Practice!

Kristi reviews some key points from the brochure.

Instructions: Cross out the extra word in each sentence. Rewrite the sentences on the lines. Practice saying the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. PowerPoint presentations are a great way to support a speech in order and to focus attention on a subject.

2. Following these suggestions will be useful for to avoiding the most common mistakes.

3. If you want to play with colors, always keep contrast in mind so as if to ensure that the text is easy to read.

4. Your audience wants to have a visual representation of what you're talking about in so order to better understand your message.



Let's Practice!

It has been said that a picture is worth a thousand words!

Instructions: Read the dialogue again. Draw a line in order to match the sentences. Read the complete sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

COLUMN A

1. It has been claimed
2. It has not been mentioned as often
3. It has been pointed out
4. Presenters are often requested
5. It's thought that

COLUMN B

- a. to use a font size that is large enough to read from a distance.
- b. that is important to be consistent in your choices.
- c. images are key elements of every presentation.
- d. that presentations should be very appealing to look at.
- e. that the messages on your page are more important than anything else.





Extension Activity

Critique a presentation using the information from this lesson.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Find a PowerPoint slideshow or some other type of presentation.
- With a partner, talk about what makes a good presentation. Consider the suggestions in this lesson and your own ideas.
- Go online to find more ideas about how to make an effective presentation.
- Write a paragraph of 80 - 100 words critiquing (evaluating) the presentation you found. Talk about the good things and the bad things about it.
- Proofread your paragraph for correct spelling and punctuation.
- Read your paragraph to a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I read and discuss how to make an effective presentation.

☐ ☐

I write a paragraph giving my critique of a presentation.

☐ ☐

I read my paragraph to a partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- attention span** (noun): the amount of time and energy a person gives to studying and understanding a situation
e.g. In reality, each slide should be very basic and simple owing to our limited attention spans.
- the opposite result** (expression): not what is expected; the opposing thing
e.g. A bad presentation can lead to the opposite result.
- poor** (adjective): bad
e.g. Poor design choices can have a very negative impact on a presentation.
- circumstance** (noun): situation
e.g. Whether you are describing your data or explaining circumstances, you'll want to tell a story.
- font face** (noun): the style of the letters on a page or a screen
e.g. You should use the same font face and sizes on all slides.
- font size** (noun): how big or small the letters on a page or screen appear
e.g. Presenters are often requested to use a font size that is large enough to read from a distance.





Learning Points

Report Verbs and Impersonal Passive Constructions

When you report beliefs and information that other people have, you can use report verbs such as *think*, *claim*, *mention*, *request* and *point out*.

You often use these report verbs with impersonal passive constructions. These are types of sentences that don't refer to any person or thing specifically.

For example:

It's thought that *the CEO earns too much money.*

You can introduce a statement with impersonal references such as *They say*, *think*, *believe* ... or *It is said*, *thought*, *believed* ...

For example:

It's thought that *CEOs make too much money.* (= CEOs are believed to make too much money).

Examples:

- *It has been claimed that presentations should be very appealing to look at.*
- *It has not been mentioned as often that the messages on your page, either through words, images or illustrations, are much more important than anything else.*
- *It has been pointed out that it is important to be consistent in your choices.*

How to Add Visuals to a Presentation

Visuals can support your presentation, but it is important to know how to use them effectively.

Here are some tips to keep in mind when adding visuals to your presentation at work:

- Be consistent with color and font size. Having too much variety can make you appear disjointed and can be distracting for your audience. Match the color with the tone of your presentation (lively or conservative).
- Consider the culture of the people you are presenting to. Avoid any images or font colors that may be offensive to others.
- Use images in a memorable way. Choose images that tell a story and that help your audience remember them.
- If you have a lot of information, break it down into smaller points. Do not overwhelm your audience.
- Keep your slides simple and clean.

